

indexed by search engines in order to increase the chance of a site or page being placed close to the beginning of search engine results, or to influence the category to which the page is assigned.

“Google bombing” is another form of search engine result manipulation, which involves placing hyperlinks that directly affect the rank of other sites. Some blogs are created for monetising the site using advertising programs such as Google AdSense. Such “Made for AdSense” (MFA) blogs have no redeeming value except to get visitors to the site for the sole purpose of clicking on advertisements. MFA sites are considered to be spamming search engines and providing surfers with less-than-satisfactory search results.

These types of sites are being eliminated in various search engines, and sometimes show up as *supplemental results* instead of being displayed in the main results.

6.1.3 The Legalities

Blogging has brought with it a range of legal liabilities—employers have fired employees who maintain personal blogs that discuss their employers. The major areas of concern are the issues of proprietary or confidential information, and defamation. Several cases have been brought before the national courts against bloggers, and the courts have returned with mixed verdicts.

In Britain, a college lecturer contributed to a blog in which she referred to a politician (who had also expressed his views in the same blog) using various uncomplimentary names, including referring to him as a “Nazi.” The politician found out the real name of the lecturer (she wrote under a pseudonym) via the ISP, and successfully sued her for £10,000 (Rs 9 lakh) in damages and £7,200 (Rs 6.5 lakh) in costs.

In India, blogger Gaurav Sabnis resigned from IBM after his posts exposing the false claims of a management school, IIPM, led to the IIPM management threatening to burn their IBM laptops as a sign of protest against him.